

## Further comparisons between Agile and DevOps

### Agility

*DevOps*: Agility in both development and operations

*Agile*: Agility only in development

### Process or practice?

*DevOps*: Involves processes such as CI, CD, CT, etc.

*Agile*: Involves practices such as Agile

Scrum, Agile Kanban, etc.

### Key focus area

*DevOps*: Timeliness and quality have equal priority

*Agile*: Timeliness is the main priority

### Release cycles/development sprints

*DevOps*: Smaller release cycles with immediate feedback

*Agile*: Smaller release cycles

### Source of feedback

*DevOps*: Feedback is from self (monitoring tool)

*Agile*: Feedback is from the customer

### Scope of work

*DevOps*: This mainly focuses on achieving automation by orchestrating various DevOps tools

*Agile*: Speed or agility only

## Why is DevOps gaining immense popularity?

DevOps is a broadly acknowledged IT practice across organisations, among development and IT operations professionals. It focuses on the idea of better communication between teams and departments for better teamwork.

## Why is DevOps better than Agile?

Let's consider the challenges with Agile software development. Agile software development is a set of best practices for creating quality software in a timely manner. But the problem is, the best practices that are followed involve people working in silos — people working as developers, as testers, or as IT ops with very little communication between them. So they are not aware what those in other teams are working on, despite being a part of the same process.

This working of teams in silos is the reason for the blame game that goes on when software fails or has major flaws. When a client has complaints about software, the development team points fingers at the QA team, which will then point fingers at the IT ops team, which will redirect the blame to the dev team.

## The solution to this problem is DevOps

In DevOps, the dev team, the IT ops team and the QA teams do not independently work at pieces of the project, but work as one, collaboratively.

The DevOps engineers do everything — develop code, test it and deploy it in production. This solves many problems as they are the sole owners of the project and have full ownership of the process.

What makes DevOps efficient is:

1. Continuous business planning
2. Collaborative development
3. Continuous testing
4. Continuous releases and development
5. Continuous user feedback and optimisation
6. Continuous monitoring

## Can Agile and DevOps work together?

Agile and DevOps may have different goals to achieve, but they can be implemented together for a successful project. Will Kinard, MD, BoxBoat, mentions that it “uses the Agile methodology as a motivator for developing a DevOps culture.” As far as he's concerned, when it comes to developing software faster and maintaining software more efficiently, both have a big role to play. “The two terms are certainly different; Agile focuses on an iterative approach to development, and DevOps brings two traditionally separate practices together — development and operations, which are normally isolated. But the ultimate goal of each one is to create further collaboration,” Kinard continues. “So, while Agile and DevOps each refer to two different things, use one to enable the other,” he concludes.

DevOps does not replace Agile; however the two complement each other very well. Agile and DevOps seek to deliver value to the end user in a more well organised way — but from different perspectives. Agile focuses on making developers and the development cycles more competent, while DevOps brings the operations team into play to allow continuous integration and continuous releases. **END** 🐧

## References

- [1] <https://www.wikipedia.org/>
- [2] <https://www.devops.com>
- [3] <https://www.agilealliance.com>

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